

Ian Strouse

Full Stack Engineer

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Profile

Full-stack engineer, ten years, including six running a studio I co-founded. Most of my work has been on software that's load-bearing and invisible: the app that runs a manufacturing line, the pipeline behind a legal document product, the internal tools a business moves on. Backend, APIs, and databases run deepest. The seam between a system and the people who depend on it is where I'm most useful.

Skills

JavaScript / TypeScript	React + Next.js	GraphQL	AWS	Microservices
Python	Node.js + Express	SQL + Postgres	REST API	System Design

Experience

FULL-STACK SOFTWARE ENGINEER – PRODUCTION, WAVELYNX; BROOMFIELD, CO — SEPT 2025 - PRESENT

Physical access control hardware, ~100 people. Manufactures door readers at roughly 10,000 units/month, most of them white-labeled by large resellers. Sole engineer on internal manufacturing software systems.

- Own the two software systems the manufacturing floor runs on: a Python/Kivy application on Raspberry Pi stations that programs and tests every reader built, and a PHP/MongoDB order management app integrated with NetSuite. ~10,000 readers per month pass through this code.
- Consolidated a two-stage programming and test process into a single 3-minute cycle by delivering firmware and configuration together over OSDP file transfer, replacing a separate pre-weld J-TAG flash. Eliminated 4 stations, 1–2 operators per shift, and the handling of partially assembled units between phases.
- Built an OSDP firmware upgrade tool in one week after a field defect was traced to all ~50,000 readers shipped to date; deployed in time for the first RMA returns, with thousands of units since reprogrammed and returned to customers.
- Traced ~50 duplicate serial numbers through weeks of production logs to several distinct causes, both programmatic and procedural, and implemented fixes across both. Zero recurrences.
- Restored out-of-sync Ansible playbooks to make production stations rebuildable from scratch rather than from disk images, then partnered on an over-the-air partitioning scheme for remote re-imaging of a fleet that grew from 4 to 18 stations.
- Expanded automated test coverage with keypad actuation (Python driving a motor in the test fixture), Wiegand, and additional card-read tests; rebuilt the shared ZPL label library to handle custom formats for 5 reseller brands.

FULL STACK ENGINEER, PRODUCTPLAN; DENVER, CO — DEC 2024 - JUL 2025

Product roadmapping SaaS, ~50 people. Rails/React/PostgreSQL monolith, 3–4 engineer product team.

- Built an AI feature on AWS Bedrock that surfaced themes across customer ideas and suggested new Opportunities, shipped to customers; made AI training a formal quarterly objective beforehand to prepare for the project.
- Extended third-party integration handling to support multiple Azure accounts per customer, previously limited to one, after the company's largest customer made it a priority.
- Identified during a self-directed review of the codebase that React could replace one of two legacy templating engines — an option no one on the team had found — then used it to build the integration plumbing behind a new set of AI configuration screens.
- Researched and selected a rich text editor (Slate.js) compatible with both Rails and React, supporting the repositioning of "Opportunities" into "Initiatives," which shipped with rich text editing, linking, and roadmap integration.
- Built multi-type timeline legends driven by data from linked Opportunities and Initiatives, giving users more control over how portfolio views read.

BACKEND ENGINEER, DISCOVERY GENIE; DENVER, CO — JAN 2022 - DEC 2024

Legal tech. Document production for solo and small-firm litigators. Three-person engineering team.

- Own the API and database for a document pipeline that ingests, categorizes, and prepares discovery material for court filing; increasingly share devops responsibility with the CTO.
- Led the backend of a year-long rebuild that split a monolith into separate front-end and back-end services, introducing TypeScript and GraphQL with the schema as a single source of truth and codegen producing matching types across the stack. That rebuild is still the running product four years later.
- Moved document conversion out of a serial service into parallelized AWS Lambdas, building a Docker image on a LibreOffice base to handle conversion across image, document, and email formats. Job times fell from tens of minutes to under one.
- Built a flat-rate subscription option and rebuilt the Stripe integration to support it, giving a bootstrapped company recurring revenue for the first time and removing per-job cost decisions for heavy users.
- Shipped AI-assisted search across full document text rather than metadata alone, plus an analyzer that generates titles and metadata for ingested documents.
- Launched PDF Concierge, a separate bulk conversion and indexing product built on the same codebase and infrastructure.

CO-FOUNDER, GOOWEE; BOULDER, CO — OCT 2016–MAR 2022

Two-principal web development and design studio. 26 clients over six years, ~15 under management at peak.

- Took over a stalled legal tech product three months into development — a handful of routes and a few bare screens — and built it to launch: backend in Node and PostgreSQL, migration from Heroku to AWS alongside the client's CTO, and the AWS services behind its document processing. Shipped mid-2019.
- Built that product's two-way integration with Clio, the dominant practice management platform for small law firms, syncing cases, documents, and billable hours in both directions. Launched at ClioCon 2020; the resulting marketplace listing has produced several hundred signups and remains a primary acquisition channel.
- Developed web applications for three additional clients across construction dispatch, family law, and a cybersecurity talent marketplace, on stacks ranging from vanilla JS and jQuery to React, Node, Express, and PostgreSQL.
- Built and ran the hosting and maintenance practice: WordPress sites on DigitalOcean for up to 15 concurrent clients, maintained in batches for efficiency, with a Kubernetes health-check service that detected downed sites and restarted them automatically.
- Rebuilt the client pipeline from nothing after the studio lost its only project in 2017, through direct outreach to local businesses, chamber of commerce membership, and startup community events. Co-organized the Boulder React Meetup for two years.

DESKTOP SUPPORT SPECIALIST, MENTAL HEALTH PARTNERS; BOULDER, CO — MAY 2010–MAY 2013

Community mental health center, 500 staff.

- Sole first-line technical support for 500 clinical and administrative staff across a main center, ten satellite clinics, and roughly ten schools in Boulder and Broomfield counties, fielding requests at a walk-up window, by phone, and by ticket. Imaged and deployed machines across all sites, administered Active Directory accounts and permissions, and handled file recovery.
- Started a repository of plain-language computer help guides — begun as notes for myself, grown into a reference library used across the organization.
- Led computer orientation for every incoming wave of new hires, 20–30 people every month or two, for three years.

Education

Galvanize, Boulder — Full Stack Web Development, 2016
University of Utah, Salt Lake City — Film Studies, 2005

Other

Co-Organizer | Boulder React Meetup, Boulder 2017–2020
Education Volunteer | Peace Corps, Madagascar 2013–2015
Support Member | Rocky Mountain Rescue, Boulder 2010–2013